The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY KEY NUMBERS FROM THE INBOX ON X CYCLE TRACKER EVENTS

KOSPI (INTRADAY, 13:20 KST)
5,540.82 −3.94% · Samsung −3.33% · SK hynix −4.62% · SOX Mon +1.61%, MU +2.97% to $904.90

DDR5 16GB SPOT
$60.70 +0.11% · TrendForce 2026-10-20 11:00 GMT+8 · DDR4 16Gb $83.364 (−0.06%)

LEAD STORY

KOREA · CONTRACTS VS. THE TAPE

Samsung Has Already Sold 80% of Its 2027 Memory Output, KB Says, but Seoul Marks Chipmakers Down Again

The Kospi fell almost 4% by early afternoon. SK hynix led the losses as regulators said Solidigm's planned U.S. listing may break Korea's dual-listing rules. Wall Street's Monday rebound did not carry over to Seoul.

By the Memory Cycle Desk · Tel Aviv · Data as of ~08:25 IDT · Korea prices intraday · CONFIRMED unless marked

KEY NUMBERS · THE CYCLE IN NUMBERS

SAMSUNG 2027 (KB SECURITIES)

2027 output under LTAs	**~80%**
2027 operating profit	**₩555T (+51%)**
HBM ASP, 2027	**+100–150%**

CXMT 3Q GUIDE, Q/Q

Revenue / net profit	**+15–20% / +1–4%**

KOREA, TUE 13:20 KST

Samsung / SK hynix	**−3.33% / −4.62%**
Foreign + institutional net selling	**₩2.1T**
Fwd P/E, Samsung / SKH	**3.4× / 2.9×**

US, MONDAY CLOSE

SOX / MU / SNDK	**+1.61% / +2.97% / +5.53%**

Sources: KB Securities via The Korea Herald; Eastmoney via TrendForce; Etoday; Shinhan via Financial News; TradingKey.

KB Securities' head of research, Kim Dong-won, estimates that Samsung has signed long-term agreements covering **about 80% of its planned 2027 memory output**. That includes five-year contracts for 70% of its conventional DRAM and NAND and commitments for all of its projected HBM. "Competition among hyperscalers to secure supplies continues even for the remaining 20 percent," he wrote. KB forecasts 2027 operating profit of **₩555 trillion, up 51%**, and HBM selling prices **up 100–150%** as HBM4 rises to 80% of HBM revenue (The Korea Herald). Micron said on Sept. 30 that more than 75% of its 2027 output was already committed.

The market did not trade on it. By 13:20 Seoul time the Kospi was down **3.94% at 5,540.82**, after touching 5,493.24 (−4.76%). Foreigners sold ₩1.11 trillion and institutions ₩989 billion, while retail investors bought ₩1.63 trillion. Samsung was down 3.33% and SK hynix 4.62% (Etoday). On Monday the Financial Supervisory Service governor told lawmakers that he and the FSC had judged Solidigm's possible U.S. IPO to be "a violation of [rules on] dual listing." The FSC is waiting for a ruling on whether the IPO needs a domestic securities filing (Reuters). A governance group called it an "unprecedented five-tier dual listing" (The Korea Economic Daily).

Shinhan's Noh Dong-gil says the stocks have fallen on multiples, not earnings. From Sept. 23 to Oct. 19, Samsung fell 23.6% and SK hynix 31.4%, while their 12-month forward EPS estimates rose 1.8% and 3.3%. Forward P/Es are down to **3.4× and 2.9×**. "High margins mean high investment costs for customers," he said, so prices also get renegotiated. Still, "spot memory prices and earnings outlooks remain solid" (Financial News). In New York on Monday the SOX rose **1.61%**, ending an eight-day losing streak; Micron gained 2.97% to $904.90 and Sandisk 5.53% (TradingKey).

Our call: late upcycle, tight through 2027, unchanged; a small nudge looser on near-term commodity pricing (below), offset by more of 2027 under contract. CYCLE SIGNAL: VISIBILITY UP, UPSIDE CAPPED

PRICING MOMENTUM · CHINA AND PCS

CXMT's Profit Growth Slows to 1–4% as DRAM Price Gains Cool, and PC Makers Say Contracts Will End Their Shortage

CXMT guided third-quarter revenue **up 15–20% from the second quarter**, but net profit up only **1–4%**, to RMB 53.4–54.9 billion. Its second-quarter profit had more than doubled. Eastmoney blames moderating DRAM price gains (TrendForce). Chinese module maker Longsys expects third-quarter profit to fall by **up to 49%** from the second quarter. Over the same three months Taiwan's Nanya grew revenue 62% (@Schulz_Research on X). CXMT says its fabs are full, and it reports on Oct. 31. In PCs, Lenovo, HP and Dell have signed LTAs with memory makers. One executive said they got "only 70% to 80% of the DRAM and SSDs we requested" in the first half, and "we do not expect major procurement problems next year." Weaker consumer demand is part of the relief: Omdia says PC shipments fell **21%** in the third quarter. DRAM and SSD prices are still expected to rise next year, but more slowly (Electronic Times). CYCLE SIGNAL: PRICE MOMENTUM

SUPPLY · TAIWAN

Micron's Taoyuan Union Calls a Solidarity Strike at Its DRAM and HBM Hub



Photo: Reuters via The Straits Times

The union for Micron workers in Taoyuan says it will strike to coincide with the company's mediation talks with its Taichung union. The dispute is over profit-sharing (Reuters). Micron employs about **15,000 people** in Taiwan and makes DRAM and HBM there. Taoyuan mediation failed in September; the Taichung union, at Micron's largest Taiwan site, has not voted. Reports differ on the date: The Straits Times' version says Oct. 20, while Commercial Times, also citing Reuters, says the 22nd, the day of the Taichung talks. The union has not said how long the strike will last, and no output impact has been reported. On X, @jukan05 argues that any disruption helps Samsung and SK hynix more than Micron. DATE UNCONFIRMED

FROM THE INBOX · SINCE OCT 19, 08:10 IDT

NEW **Tools "effectively sold out."** At least 8 quarters of visibility; ASML customers placing orders into CY29–30; CY27 WFE $215B (+39%), maybe $225B; LRCX a top pick into Wednesday's print. Cantor, Oct 19

NEW **Micron contracts could cover half of revenue.** 16 strategic customer agreements, 14 with pricing terms, could reach 50% of revenue, up from 25% in the May quarter and 35% in August. SECONDARY Cantor, relayed Oct 19

NEW **Shortages move down the chain.** Unimicron sees PCB substrate materials 20% short in 2027; some tool lead times are 30 months. SEMCO signed a ₩360B 12-month 2027 supply deal; some clients think the customer is Micron. Unimicron; Jefferies Asia, Oct 20

Jefferies memory bull/bear call, Thu Oct 22, 16:00 IDT, with an ex-Samsung SVP. Topics: CXMT, YMTC's IPO, HBM spec cuts for Rubin Ultra, and whether supply loosens 2–3 quarters out. Jefferies, Oct 19

ON X · SINCE LAST EDITION

@Schulz_Research
CXMT Q3 revenue +15–20%, profit +1–4% q/q; Nanya revenue +62%, net income +75% over the same three months.
x.com/.../2112266418809192806

@pequityresearch SECONDARY
DS Investment: with 3-yr DRAM ASP −32% and NAND −39%, makers keep 80–90% of 2027 peak profit.
x.com/.../2112214188990873860

@jukan05
Samsung Electro-Mechanics signs an LTA with Micron for BT and ABF substrates for enterprise SSDs (Korean media).
x.com/.../2112327685540380724

@RealNickMugalli SECONDARY
Goldman: MU, SKH, SNDK below book imply the market already prices a 2028 downcycle.
x.com/.../2112305183577305575

X API posts; broker views relayed on X are secondary (notes not seen). Also: China's draft export catalog restricts 3D flash design tech (comments to Nov 15).

CYCLE TRACKER

Unchanged: more of 2027 locked in, commodity momentum cooling

GAUGE	TODAY VS OCT 19 (GUIDANCE: NO NEW DATA)	NUDGE
Contract ROC	CXMT profit +1–4% q/q on cooling DRAM gains; Longsys down up to 49%; KB: Samsung HBM ASP +100–150% in '27	**Commodity cooling**
Spot vs contract	DDR5 $60.70 (+0.11%); DDR4 $83.36 vs $50 last public contract; some suppliers trimming quotes (TF)	**Flat**
Contracts / inventory	Samsung ~80% of '27 booked; PC OEMs' LTAs done; PC units −21% in 3Q	**Visibility up; PC easing**
Lead times / capex	Tools sold out ~8 qtrs; substrates 20% short in '27	**Tight**
CXMT	Fabs full, profit growth stalling; Q3 on Oct 31	**Price-driven**
Valuation / flows	Fwd P/E 3.4× / 2.9×; GS: 0.9× 2028 book; ₩2.1T sold by 13:20	**Pricing a downturn**

VERDICT
Late upcycle; tight through 2027, unchanged. A small nudge looser near term: CXMT's profit is up only 1–4% q/q, which Eastmoney puts down to cooling DRAM price gains; Longsys' profit falls by up to 49%; and PC makers say LTAs and weaker demand end their shortage next year. Visibility is firmer: KB estimates Samsung has ~80% of 2027 booked and all of its HBM committed, and Micron has more than 75%. Spot prices are flat and the 2028 view is unchanged. Flows still drive the stocks: Seoul was down almost 4% despite a Monday rebound in the U.S.

EVENTS CALENDAR · OCT 20–NOV 1 · ISRAEL TIME

When	Event	Watch
Wed 21 · 03:00	Korea Oct 1–20 exports (customs)	chip exports
Wed 21 · AMC	Lam Research (call 00:00 Thu) · TI · Meta	WFE / capex
Thu 22	BoK · Micron Taichung talks · Jefferies memory call 16:00 · WDC	HBM / HDD
Wed 28	SK hynix 3Q26 02:00 · FOMC 20:00 · KLA, MSFT, GOOGL	HBM / rates

Thu 29	Samsung 3Q26 03:00 · Sandisk, Intel, Amazon AMC	HBM / NAND
Fri 30 – Sat 31	Kioxia, Tokyo Electron · CXMT Q3 (Oct 31)	NAND / China

IDT to Oct 24, IST from Oct 25. Also: Seagate Oct 27; Korea Oct exports Nov 1 ~02:00; TrendForce month-end contracts (date TBA); China export-catalog comments close Nov 15.

SOURCES & FURTHER READING

- The Korea Herald: Samsung's 2027 memory output already 80% booked (KB Securities)
- Financial News: Strong earnings aren't enough — Samsung, SK hynix falter
- The Korea Economic Daily: SK hynix, SK Square fall on Solidigm noise (Korean)
- Electronic Times: PC makers see memory supply relief
- Commercial Times: Micron Taoyuan strike, Taichung talks (Chinese)
- Etoday: Foreign, institutional selling drags Kospi to 5,540 (Korean)
- Reuters via MarketScreener: Solidigm listing could violate dual-listing rules
- TrendForce: CXMT's 3Q profit growth slows to 1–4% QoQ
- Reuters via The Straits Times: Micron union in Taiwan to launch strike
- TradingKey: US close — memory stocks lead, Micron up nearly 3%

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #14 · Oct 20, 2026